

St. Aakash Memorial Hospital

Infection Control Department — Policy Document

Document No.	ICD-POL-014
Title	Hand Hygiene Policy
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Approved By	Dr. R. Mehta, Infection Control Officer

1. Purpose

This policy establishes the standard for hand hygiene practice across all clinical and non-clinical staff at St. Aakash Memorial Hospital, in order to reduce the risk of healthcare-associated infections (HAI).

2. Scope

Applies to all doctors, nursing staff, paramedical staff, housekeeping staff, and visitors entering clinical care areas including the ICU, wards, OPD, and operation theatre complex.

3. Indications for Hand Hygiene

All staff shall perform hand hygiene before touching a patient, before any clean or aseptic procedure, after exposure to body fluid, after touching a patient, and after touching patient surroundings. Staff are trained on these five indications during induction.

4. Technique

Hand hygiene shall be performed using either an alcohol-based handrub (preferred, when hands are not visibly soiled) or soap and water (when hands are visibly soiled), following the standard rub/wash technique for a minimum duration of 20 seconds.

5. Training

All new staff undergo hand hygiene training during induction. Refresher training is conducted annually for clinical staff.

6. Monitoring and Compliance Audit

[Section intentionally left incomplete in this version — monitoring methodology, audit frequency, and compliance scoring to be finalized by the Infection Control Committee in the next policy]

revision cycle.]

7. Responsibility

The Infection Control Officer is responsible for policy review. Department heads are responsible for ensuring staff compliance within their respective units.

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